

Decision Maker				
You need	Boasting rights A very tiny phone, funky backlight, rich-sounding ring tones, faceplates with striking colours and design		Functionality A phone that supports the best in wireless communications technology with good PIM functionality and productivity features that are aimed at practical usability	
Look for	Phones that comfortably fit in the palm of your hand, with a weight of less than 85 grams, fluorescent backlights, polyphonic ring tones, MP3 and FM capability, ring tone composer and the capability to download ring tones and screensavers		Support for GPRS and Bluetooth, integrated reminders, to-do lists and calendar, extensive memory for addresses and messages	
Our recommendations	Price-conscious	Money no bar	Price-conscious	Money no bar
	Panasonic EB-GD75, Samsung SGH-R220, Nokia 3350	Sony Ericsson T68i, Nokia 8310 or 5510, Samsung SGH-M100	Siemens M35i, Nokia 6210, Panasonic EB-GD75	Sony Ericsson T68i, Nokia 8310, Siemens ME45, Motorola V.66
Price range	Rs 9,000 to Rs 10,500	Rs 21,000 to Rs 28,000	Rs 9,000 to Rs 11,000	Rs 19,000 to Rs 28,000

technologies like MMS that will let you send multimedia content to other capable phones just as we do SMS messages today. This phone stood apart from the pack with its very appealing pearl colour scheme and one of the largest screens that we have seen in a cellular phone. Add to this is the brilliant 256-colour screen that brings your phone to life with support for thematic backgrounds and GIF images.



Nokia 5510

message storing capability and WAP support, and still being available at a very attractive price. High-end: The cell phone that undoubtedly came out tops in this comparison was the Sony Ericsson T68i. In a package that fits well and feels great in the

palm of one's hand, this phone incorporated some of the most cutting-edge features ever seen on a mobile device. Even though GPRS is just about catching on in India, this phone comes well prepared for the onslaught of mobile multimedia with its support for GPRS and with

Bluetooth capability lets this device talk to other compliant devices, opening up a whole new world of pervasive wireless communication and data exchange. To top it all, the GUI control is one of the easiest to learn and get used to—the integrated joystick makes navigation through the phone very simple and highly intuitive. With support for bleeding-edge wireless technologies, enormous phone and message storage capabilities and a host of other very intuitive features, this phone wins the Best Performance Award with ease.

In this category, the phone that bagged the Best Value Award was the Nokia 5510. With a plethora of features and functionality integrated into it (a 64 MB MP3 player, FM tuner and enhanced SMS functionality), this phone is much more than a communications device.

We have reached a runway of sorts for mobile communication. From here on, newer technologies and enhancements to existing wireless networks are going to fuel a takeoff for cellular technology as we know it. The effects of this change are already being experienced—through GPRS, lower costs of rentals and network usage, and phones that incorporate newer and cooler features at lower prices. Get ready for the next generation of communication where you will be able to stay connected at all times to the people who matter to you and the information that you need the most. ■

Motorola V.66

This little phone, based on a flip-type construction, features some impressive characteristics. Capable of GPRS and WAP, the monochrome display integrated into the top half of the device features sharp graphics. It uses a Li-Ion battery. An interesting feature is that the SIM card bay is separate from the battery bay: each is in one half of the phone. The phone has tri-band functionality—you can use it in all three types of GSM networks, GSM 900, GSM 1800 and GSM 1900. Weighing a mere 78.75 grams, this was the lightest phone in this roundup. However, with the flip-type construction, the phone is very prone to damage since there are moving parts in its construction. Great PIM functionality is provided in this phone with support for reminders, To-do lists and a calendar for keeping track of schedules and appointments. Another impressive feature is the massive 500-entry phonebook memory. In the tests, the network sensitivity of this phone was particularly commendable; it registered a good signal in places where other phones were not as effective. However, the logged talk time of this phone is not very good; it drained out in a shade under one-and-a-half hours. Also, even though it was clear, the voice volume of the phone was a little soft compared to other phones even when it was set to the maximum level. This feature-packed phone, with its small form factor and support for cutting-edge standards like GPRS, is suitable for users who need a lightweight cellular device with added functionality such as scheduling and a large phonebook.

Motorola V.66

Ergonomics	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Warranty	▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶

B+

Price: Rs 19,000

+ Very light, impressive PIM functionality, large phonebook memory

- Flip-type construction is prone to breakage, voice loudness is lower than other phones

